

COULD BE BIG MAN

Ron Jackson Big 'If' For White Sox

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CHICAGO (AP) — Ron Jackson could be the big man for the Chicago White Sox in more ways than one.

At 6-feet-7, he's already the giant of the Sox infield—and possibly any other infield.

Now he has a chance to be Chicago's big man at the plate, too.

Since the Sox traded off hitting strength in deals that cost them Minnie Minoso and Larry Doby, they are without a solid cleanup hitter.

Manager Al Lopez thinks Jackson could be his man. The big first baseman is getting every chance to prove himself in the exhibition games. All he has to do is beat out more seasoned hitters like Walt Dropo and Earl Torgeson.

"A man Jackson's size will be of value to us only if he hits home runs," says Lopez. "I've told him that and we are getting him to pull the ball more."

"When Ron came back to us late last season he said he had a great year hitting .310 with 21 home runs and 102 runs batted in for Indianapolis."

"I told him he had better not regard that as 'a great year' because .310 in the American Assn.

means a lot less in the American League."

Ron, a big man who weighs 240



RON JACKSON

pounds, has had a major league contract ever since Chicago signed him out of Western Michigan College in 1954 for a \$30,000 bonus. But this is his first real chance with the White Sox. In four years he has been in 115 Sox games, showing nine homers and a .254 average.

He spent most of 1956 on option to Vancouver, then a Baltimore farm in the Pacific Coast League. He hit .304. Last year in 143 games for Indianapolis, a sixth place club, he showed good power with 59 of his 166 hits going for extra bases.

Jackson feels that playing every day last year gave him his big chance. He was hitting third and fourth for Indianapolis Manager Andy Cohen, who figures Ron is ready. Lefty O'Doul, his Vancouver manager, also believes he will make the grade.

Jackson, 24, used most of his bonus money to buy a home in Kalamazoo, Mich., where he lives with his wife, Carol, and two children, Mark, 4, and Martha, 2.

He was an unusual bonus player in that the Sox never had to fear about losing him to the service.

"I was too tall for the Army," says Jackson. "I was in the ROTC before I found that out."